

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Mob-connected businessman indicted

Associate of Outfit's Grand Avenue crew hit with charges alleging hidden interest in gaming company

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A mob-connected Chicago businessman has been indicted on tax evasion charges alleging he had a hidden interest in a sweepstakes gaming company run by the now-imprisoned son-in-law of Joe Berrios, the former Cook County assessor.

Robert “Bobby” Dominic, 71, a longtime associate of the Outfit’s Grand Avenue crew known for his connections to Richard’s Bar on the Near West Side, was charged in a five-count indictment made public Tuesday in U.S. District Court with tax evasion and failure to file tax returns.

An arraignment date has not been set. The docket showed that

Dominic, of Morton Grove, is currently representing himself. He could not be reached for comment.

The indictment alleged that from 2014 to 2020, Dominic was secretly paid hundreds of thousands of dollars from two sweepstakes gaming companies through a sham entity owned by his then-girlfriend.

A month after his girlfriend died in January 2020, Dominic allegedly set up another phony company through another woman, identified only as Individual B, and

continued to receive payments from the sweepstakes businesses, according to the indictment.

On March 30, 2021, the stock certificate for Sham Company B “was amended to reflect that all shares were to transfer to Dominic upon Individual B’s death,” the indictment stated.

Last fall, the U.S. attorney’s office subpoenaed Individual B to appear before a federal grand jury investigating Dominic, and sent a letter to her attorney indicating she would be compelled to testify through a

grant of immunity, according to the indictment.

A few days before her scheduled grand jury appearance on Oct. 7, 2024, however, Individual B, who at the time was 80 years old, agreed to marry Dominic in order to prevent her testimony, the indictment stated.

State records show Dominic’s wife, who is not charged, formed a company generically titled Promotional Consulting Inc. on Sept. 19,

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Michael Apke watches a plane land next to a remotely operated camera on the roof of his Pro Auto repair shop on Tuesday just outside Midway International Airport after the camera caught a near collision between two planes earlier in the day. He owns the repair shop and leases space for cameras. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Southwest plane, business jet nearly hit on Midway runway

Unclear how close aircraft came to colliding, but it’s not first close call at airport

By Sarah Freishtat
Chicago Tribune

Federal authorities are investigating two jets that appeared to narrowly avoid a collision at Midway Airport, as a string of recent aviation disasters has caused public confidence in air safety to start to waver.

Around 8:50 a.m. Tuesday, a Southwest plane aborted a landing when a business jet entered the runway without authorization, according to the Federal Aviation Administration, which is investigating the incident.

Video circulating on social media shows a dramatic reversal of plans by the Southwest plane. The larger commercial plane appears to nearly touch down on the runway when the smaller jet begins to cross in front of it. The Southwest plane immediately pulls up and returns to the sky, while the smaller plane proceeds across the runway, the video shows.

It was unclear Tuesday afternoon exactly how close the two planes got. But it was not the first time in recent years planes



In an image from video, Southwest Airlines flight 2504 aborts a landing at Midway Airport on Tuesday after a business jet crossed the runway at Midway Airport. **STREAMTIME LIVE**

have come so close to colliding at Midway that the FAA took note.

“This reflects the extremely crowded skies that we have,” said travel industry analyst Henry Harteveldt.

Aborted landings, known in aviation as a “go around,” remain relatively unusual, and pilots train extensively to handle

those and other safety situations, Harteveldt said.

Still, FAA records describe a string of other runway incidents at Midway in the past two years that brought commercial jets, small planes, helicopters and vehicles unusually close together at the Southwest Side’s bustling, landlocked airport. In

some cases, planes were forced to abort takeoffs or landings.

In August, a helicopter was approved to fly over a Midway runway as a Boeing 737 was told to get in position to take off. The helicopter passed over the plane lower than authorized, coming

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Boy’s mom testifies at hate crime murder trial

Palestinian American paints picture of child being killed for ethnicity

By Michelle Mullins
Chicago Tribune

On the final day of his life, 6-year-old Wadee Alfayoumi ate breakfast with mother, helped her change the sheets on their beds and played an educational game on a cellphone.

The kindergartner was getting ready to take a shower when their landlord knocked on the door, his mother, Hanan Shaheen, testified Tuesday.

In the moments that followed, Joseph Czuba — who owned the home in unincorporated Plainfield where the family rented two bedrooms — charged at Shaheen and stabbed her with a knife, she testified. She said he screamed during the rampage about the war between Israel and Hamas.

And when Shaheen was able to get away and lock herself in the bathroom, Czuba turned his anger on Wadee and killed him, she said.

Shaheen offered the heart-wrenching testimony on the first day of Czuba’s murder trial, painting a portrait of her son as a typical American boy who was violently attacked because of his ethnicity and hostilities happening half a world away.

Wadee, who had recently celebrated a birthday, was stabbed 26 times on Oct. 14, 2023. Prosecutors say the slaying was fueled by Czuba’s prejudice against Palestinians and his anger over the Hamas attacks on Israel a week earlier.

Czuba, 73, is charged with three counts of first-degree murder, one count of attempted murder, two counts of aggravated battery and two counts of committing a hate crime. If convicted, he could face life in prison without parole.

He has pleaded not guilty to the charges.

In October 2023, Wadee’s death heightened concerns about anti-Muslin discrimination in the Chicago area amid the then-escalating war between Israel and Hamas. Illinois also has more Muslims per capita than any other state in the United States, due in large part to the more than 85,000 Palestinians who live in Cook County.

Shaheen testified she had no issues with Czuba until the war began. After the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks, he grew angry with her because she was Muslim and was from Jerusalem, she said.

She said Czuba told her

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MATT MARTON/AP

Hawks organist goes out on a high note

Frank Pellico looks back on 33 years tickling the keyboards as the Blackhawks’ organist — and closes out with “My Way.” **Chicago Sports**

If GOP cuts Medicaid, states suffer

Health care funding going to tax cut may trigger big shortfall

By Noah Weiland
and Sarah Kliff
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — House Republicans hunting for ways to pay for President Donald Trump’s tax cuts have called for cutting the federal government’s share of Medicaid spending, including a proposal

that would effectively gut the Affordable Care Act’s 2014 expansion of the program.

Cutting Medicaid spending, which is central to the budget bill that House Republicans were trying to bring to a vote Tuesday, could result in millions of Americans across the country losing health coverage unless states decide to play a bigger role in its funding.

Republicans are considering lowering the 90% share that the federal government

is required to pay to states that enroll participants in the expansion. The change could generate \$560 billion in savings over a decade, money that Republicans want to use toward extending Trump’s 2017 tax cuts, which are set to expire at the end of 2025. Extending the tax cuts is expected to cost \$4.5 trillion, meaning Republicans will have to find savings beyond Medicaid from a long menu of

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TODAY’S WEATHER

High **52**
Low **37**



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 57
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